Prologue

When I reflect upon my life, I can clearly see how my passion for running has dominated my life. The images that flash through my mind are those of me running…running…running…

- sprinting from one shady patch to another to escape the blistering heat of the sun on my journey to school
- fleeing the massacre on that fearsome night when most of my family was slaughtered
- racing trains for fun
- outrunning the police when I was caught stealing in Shahdara
- leaving everyone behind in my first race as an army jawan so that I could get an extra glass of milk
- surging past my competitors in Tokyo when I was declared Asia's Best Athlete
- Running in Pakistan and being hailed as 'The Flying Sikh'

Each of these moments brings back bittersweet memories as they represent the different stages of my life, a life that has been kept afloat by my intense determination to triumph in my chosen vocation.